

Indian Polity and Governance

The Constitutional Development of India

1. The first Session of Constituent Assembly was held on :

- (a) 9th December, 1946 (b) 15th August, 1947
(c) 26th November, 1949 (d) 26th January, 1946
(e) None of the above / More than one of the above

66th B.P.S.C. (Pre) (Re- Exam), 2020

Ans. (a)

The Indian Constituent Assembly was established with the commencement of its first meeting on December 9, 1946.

2. Indian Constitution was adopted by the Constituent Assembly on -

- (a) 26 November, 1949 (b) 15 August, 1949
(c) 2 October, 1949 (d) 15 November, 1949

43rd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1990

Ans. (a)

The Preamble of the Constitution states, "We the People of India enact, adopt and give to ourselves this Constitution on 26 November, 1949". This date is considered as the date of adoption, completion and passing of the Constitution. On the same day the provisions relating to Citizenship, elections, provisional parliament, temporary and transitional provisions were given immediate effect. Rest of the provisions came into effect on 26 January, 1950. Thus 26 January, 1950 is considered as commencement date of the Constitution.

3. January 26 was selected as the date for the inauguration of the Constitution, because-

- (a) The Congress had observed it as the Independence Day in 1930.
(b) On that day the Quit India Movement was started in 1942.
(c) It was considered to be an auspicious day.
(d) None of the above.

53rd to 55th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2011

Ans. (a)

The Purna Swaraj declaration was promulgated by the Indian National Congress in Lahore Session (1929) where Congress asked people of India to observe 26 January as Independence

Day. After that Congress had regularly observed 26 January as the Independence Day of India. The new Constitution of India, as drafted and approved by the Constituent Assembly of India, was mandated to come into effect from 26 January 1950, to commemorate the 1929 declaration.

4. Who of the following was the Chairman of the 'Provincial Constitution Committee' of the Constituent Assembly of India?

- (a) Sardar Vallabh Bhai Patel
(b) Rajendra Prasad
(c) K. M. Munshi
(d) More than one of the above
(e) None of the above

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Ans. (a)

The Provincial Constitution Committee held its first meeting on 5 May 1947, during which Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel was unanimously elected as Chairman. However, by the time the Committee met again on 6 June, partition had been announced.

5. Who was the Labour Minister in Jawaharlal Nehru's Provisional Government?

- (a) Aruna Asaf Ali (b) C. Rajagopalachari
(c) Jagjivan Ram (d) More than one of the above
(e) None of the above

B.P.S.C. PRT 2023 Shift I

Ans. (c)

In 1946 Jagjivan Ram the Minister in Jawaharlal Nehru interim government, the first Cabinet of India as a Labour Minister and also a member of the Constituent Assembly of India, where he ensured that social justice was enshrined in the constitution.

6. Indian Constitution was adopted by -

- (a) Constituent Assembly (b) British Parliament
(c) Governor-General (d) Indian Parliament

39th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1994

Ans. (a)

The Constitution of India was officially adopted on the 26th of November, 1949 and signed by the members of the Constituent Assembly on 24th of January, 1950.

7. Constitution Day of India is celebrated on

- (a) 26th October
- (b) 26th November
- (c) 26th January
- (d) 15th August
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

60th to 62nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2016

Ans. (b)

The Constitution Day of India is celebrated on 26th November since the Constitution of India was adopted by the Constituent Assembly on 26th November, 1949 and signed by the then President Rajendra Prasad. Some of the provisions of the Constitution came into force at once while the remaining provisions of the Constitution came into force on 26th January, 1950, the commencement date of the Constitution.

8. Who was the President of the Indian National Congress at the time of partition of India?

- (a) J.B. Kripalani
- (b) Jawaharlal Nehru
- (c) Maulana Abul Kalam Azad
- (d) C. Rajagopalachari
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

65th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2019

Ans. (a)

J.B. Kripalani was the President of the Indian National Congress at the time of Partition of India.

9. In Indian political system which one is supreme?

- (a) The Supreme Court
- (b) The Constitution
- (c) The Parliament
- (d) Religion

45th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2001

Ans. (b)

The Constitution is supreme in the Indian political system. The Constitution of India is the supreme law of India. It lays down the framework defining fundamental political principles, establishes the structure, procedures, powers and duties of Government institutions and sets out fundamental rights, directive principles and the duties of the citizens.

10. Which of the following statements is true?

- (a) The Federal form of Government is in United States of America.
- (b) The government of India is federal and unitary both.
- (c) The government of France is of federal form.
- (d) The Prime Minister of Pakistan is appointed by the people.

38th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1992

Ans. (a)

The United States is a federal constitutional republic, which consists of 50 States, while India is a Union of 28 States and 8 Union Territories. Article 1 of the Indian Constitution declares it as the Union of States. A federal government is one in which there is division of powers between the central government and state governments by the Constitution itself and both operate in their respective jurisdictions independently. Some of the Constitution experts state the Indian Constitution has unitary nature because at the time of emergency it provides a strong center, but the reality is that the Indian Constitution is of federal nature having some unitary features.

11. Which of the following may be called the effect of Russian Revolution in India?

- (a) The Publication of book 'Red Revolution' by R. S. Avasthi in 1920-21
- (b) The visit of Russia by Jawaharlal Nehru and Rabindranath Tagore
- (c) The formation of communist Party in India in mid-1920s
- (d) More than one of the above
- (e) None of the above

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Ans. (d)

The Russian Revolution of 1917 had a significant impact on the Indian independence movement. The formation of the Communist Party of India in the mid-1920s was one of the direct effects, as the revolutionary ideas and principles of communism inspired many Indian nationalists.

By the mid-1920s the Communist Party was formed in India. Its members kept in touch with the Soviet Communist Party. Important Indian political and cultural figures took an interest in the Soviet experiment and visited Russia, among them Jawaharlal Nehru and Rabindranath Tagore, who wrote about Soviet Socialism. In India, writings gave impressions of Soviet Russia.

In Hindi, R.S. Avasthi wrote in 1920-21 Russian Revolution, Lenin, His Life and His Thoughts, and later The Red Revolution. S.D. Vidyalkar wrote The Rebirth of Russia and The Soviet State of Russia. There was much that was written in Bengali, Marathi, Malayalam, Tamil and Telugu.

12. In which of the following periods mainly the new type of political consciousness grew during British rule in India?

- (a) During the first half period of 20th Century
- (b) During the second half period of 19th Century
- (c) During the first half period of 19th Century